

Strong 2-♣ Opening

Open 2♣ on any hand containing 22 or more points.

OR, open 2♣ with a hand containing 19-21 points and with 9+ playing tricks.

There are several methods of responding. For these Deals use the 2♦ Negative for all hands with 7 or fewer points. Any other response shows 8 or more points.

The 2♣ bid is artificial; Opener's second bid describes her hand.

2NT shows a balanced 22-24 point hand

3NT shows a balanced 25-27 point hand

2 of a suit shows a 5-card or longer suit

With a very weak hand (0-3 points) Responder should bid the "second negative" at his second turn. This is usually 3♣, but if Opener bids 3♣ then it is 3♦. If Opener should bid 3♦ at his second turn the second negative bid is 3♥.

Later bidding depends on the partnership, but unless particular conventions are in use then later bidding is natural.

Board: 1

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4 ♠

Declarer: North

Lead: ♣ A

Board: 2

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Lead: ♠ 7

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4 ♥

Declarer: South

Lead: ♠ 4

Board: 4

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6NT

Declarer: West

Lead: ♥ 4

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 5
 ♥ 10 5 3
 ♦ 10 7 6 5 3
 ♣ K 10 2

♠ A J 10 7 2

♥ 9 8 7

♦ 8 2

♣ Q 5 3



♠ 4 3

♥ Q 6 4

♦ J 9 4

♣ A J 9 7 4

♠ K Q 8 6

♥ A K J 2

♦ A K Q

♣ 8 6

SOUTH has a minimum 2♣ opening.

NORTH, with 8 points and a 5-card suit, should make a positive response, 2♠.

SOUTH shows the ♠ support first, to set the trump suit, and to give NORTH an opportunity for a move toward slam if he wants to do so.

NORTH would now make a Control-showing bid IF HE HAD A CONTROL. Since he doesn't he just returns to 4♠ which SOUTH passes.

West	North	East	South
			2♣
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			
4♠ by North			
Lead: ♣A			

Board 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A Q 9
♥ A K 2
♦ A 8 3
♣ A J 7 4

♠ 4 2

♥ 10 9 4 3

♦ Q J 2

♣ K Q 10 2



♠ K 6 3

♥ Q 8 5

♦ K 7 6 4

♣ 9 5 3

♠ J 10 8 7 5

♥ J 7 6

♦ 10 9 5

♣ 8 6

WEST, with 22 points and balanced, opens 2♣, expecting to rebid 2NT.

But EAST responds a positive 2NT, showing a balanced hand with 8 or more points.

WEST bids what his hand is worth, 3NT and EAST passes.

West

2♣

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

Lead: ♠7

North

Pass

East

2NT

South

Pass

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 6 5 4
♥ 9 6 4 3
♦ Q J 9
♣ J 7 6

♠ Q J 7 2
♥ Q 10 7 5
♦ 7 2
♣ 8 5 4



♠ 10 8 3
♥ K
♦ K 10 8 5 4 3
♣ Q 10 2

♠ A K 9
♥ A J 8 2
♦ A 6
♣ A K 9 3

SOUTH opens 2♣ and NORTH responds 2♦ showing fewer than 8 points.

SOUTH bids 2NT with a 23 point balanced hand.

NORTH has enough points to bid 3NT, but with two 4-card Major suits bids 3♣ Stayman instead.

SOUTH won't confuse this as the second negative since that bid isn't used after a 2NT rebid.

So SOUTH shows her 4-card ♥ suit and NORTH bids 4♥.

West	North	East	South
			2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	2NT
Pass	3♣	Pass	3♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			
4♥ by South			
Lead: ♠4			

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q 6 3
♥ Q 8 5
♦ K 7 6 4
♣ K J 3

♠ J 10 8 7
♥ 4 3
♦ Q J 10 9 5
♣ 9 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A K 9
♥ A K 2
♦ A 8 3
♣ A Q 7 4

♠ 5 4 2
♥ J 10 9 7 6
♦ 2
♣ 10 8 5 2

West	North	East	South
		2♣	Pass
2NT	Pass	3NT	Pass
6NT			
All Pass			
6NT by West			
Lead: ♥4			

WEST has a balanced hand with 11 points, so she responds 2NT to EAST's 2♣ opening bid.

EAST bids 3NT. This shows 22-24 points, a hand he was planning to rebid 2NT.

WEST knows the side has at least 33 points, but no more than 35 so she bids 6NT.